

Drawing Tools and Annotations

Charts & Workspace | beginner | 5 min read | DeepCharts Help Center | August 24, 2026

Drawings — lines, levels, rectangles, Fibonacci tools, text notes — are how you mark up a DeepCharts chart. Every tool is available from two places: the left toolbar strip on the chart and the right-click menu under **Drawing Objects**, most with a keyboard shortcut.

This article lists every drawing object and its hotkey, then covers the workflows around drawings: editing and reusing styles, snapping, hiding, bulk-erasing, moving annotations between charts and machines, and keeping drawings in sync across charts of the same instrument.

What it is

The annotation system of the chart window. It answers "how do I draw X", "how do I change a drawing's color", "where did my drawings go", and "how do I get my drawings onto another chart or another PC".

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] A chart with several annotations placed — a horizontal line at a level, a trend line, a rectangle zone and a text note — with the left drawing toolbar strip visible and the right-click Drawing Objects submenu open dc-en-drawing-tools-01.png

When to use it

- Mark support/resistance levels, zones, and session extremes.
- Measure moves and plan trades (Ruler, Buy/Sell calculator).
- Annotate charts for a journal or to share as screenshots.
- Keep the same levels visible across several charts of one instrument.

Quick start

1. Right-click the chart and open **Drawing Objects**, or use the left toolbar strip (toggle it with the ≡ icon at the top left).
2. Pick a tool — for example **Horizontal Line** (Shift H) — and click on the chart to place it.
3. To edit a drawing, double left-click it (or left-click to select, then right-click → **Settings**) and change colors and styles in the Annotation Settings.
4. To remove one drawing, select it and delete it; to clear everything, use right-click → **Drawing Utilities** → **Erase All Drawing** (see the warning below).

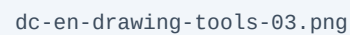
[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The Annotation Settings dialog open for a horizontal line, showing color, line style and width options dc-en-drawing-tools-02.png

Settings reference

Drawing Objects (right-click → Drawing Objects)

Tool (hotkey)	What it does
Horizontal Line (Shift H)	Price level across the chart.
Vertical Line	Marks a point in time.
Horizontal Ray	Price level starting at a point and extending right.
Line (Shift L)	Free trend line between two points.
Parallel Lines (Shift P)	Parallel channel.
Ruler	Measures between two chart points.

Tool (hotkey)	What it does
Rectangle (Shift R)	Price/time zone. If it stops responding, see Fix: Rectangle Drawing Tool Not Working.
Ellipse	Elliptical zone.
Text (Shift T)	Text note on the chart.
Pencil	Freehand drawing.
Price Retracement (Shift F)	Fibonacci retracement.
Price Projection	Fibonacci projection.
Price Fan	Fan tool — corresponds to the Fibonacci fan listed in Options → Settings → Toolbar .
Volume Profile (Shift V)	Draws a volume profile over a selected range. Concept: Understanding Volume Profile: POC, Value Area, HVN/LVN.
VWAP	VWAP drawing tool. Concept: Understanding VWAP.
Buy calculator (Shift B)	Position calculator for longs: place it, then drag the stop-loss area and the take-profit area up or down — it shows the risk/reward ratio, the price of both levels, and each level's tick distance from entry.
Sell calculator (Shift S)	The same position calculator for shorts.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] A Buy calculator drawing placed on a chart with the SL area below entry and TP area above, showing the risk/reward ratio and tick distances  dc-en-drawing-tools-03.png

Tip: The cursor-mode entries in the same right-click menu are worth memorizing: **Pointer** (Alt P), **Crosshair** (Alt C), **Global Crosshair** (Alt G — crosshair on all charts of the same instrument), **Hand** (Alt H). Hotkeys are configurable — see How to Configure Keyboard Shortcuts.

Left toolbar extras

The left strip mirrors the drawing tools (which tools appear there is configurable in **Options** → **Settings** → **Toolbar**), plus:

Icon	What it does
Eye	Hides/shows ALL drawings on the chart.
Magnet	When enabled, new drawings attach to the closest main level — the nearest candle wick high/low or open/close. Disabled = fully free placement.
Eraser	Removes drawings.

Editing and reusing styles

- **Edit:** double left-click a drawing, or select it and right-click → **Settings**.
- **Save a configuration:** store a drawing's style settings for future reuse from its settings dialog.
- **Recall a configuration:** right-click the drawing and open **Tool Config**.

Drawing Utilities (right-click → Drawing Utilities)

Item	What it does
Import Annotations	Loads drawings from a file.
Export Annotations	Saves drawings to a file — format selectable: CSV or the Volumetrica format (specific to the DeepCharts apps). This is how you move drawings between machines or share them. [CONFIRM: whether export covers all drawings or only selected ones]

Item	What it does
Snap annotation (Ctrl S)	Snapping toggle for annotations [CONFIRM: whether this is the same toggle as the magnet icon] .
Hide/Show annotations	Toggles visibility of annotations on the chart.
Erase All Drawing	Removes every drawing from the chart.

Warning: Erase All Drawing deletes all drawings on the chart in one action. Export your annotations first if there is any chance you will want them back.

Drawings across charts

- **Drawing Tool From Other Chart** (right-click menu) syncs drawings between charts — set it between, say, a 1-minute and a 5-minute chart of the same symbol, and a drawing made on one appears on the other.
- To carry a full chart setup (drawings context included) to another chart or PC, use templates and workspaces — see Templates and Workspaces.

Tips and common mistakes

- **"My drawings disappeared."** Before assuming they are lost, check the **eye** icon on the left toolbar and right-click → **Drawing Utilities** → **Hide/Show annotations** — one of the two visibility toggles is usually the cause.
- **Drawings won't land exactly on candle highs/lows** — enable the **magnet** icon so new drawings snap to the nearest wick or open/close.
- **Moving to a new PC?** Right-click → **Drawing Utilities** → **Export Annotations**, copy the file over, then **Import Annotations** on the other machine.
- **Plan the trade before placing it:** the **Buy/Sell calculator** shows risk/reward and tick distances while you drag the levels — faster than computing them by hand.
- Related chart-level options: **Options** → **Settings** → **General** → **Chart** includes annotation behaviors such as **Editable copied annotation** and **Annotations stop on last bar**.

Related articles

- The Chart Window
- Fix: Rectangle Drawing Tool Not Working
- Keyboard Shortcuts Reference
- Templates and Workspaces
- Understanding Volume Profile: POC, Value Area, HVN/LVN
- Understanding VWAP